Where are your study hours going?

Most aspirants work hard. Fewer work where the marks are. Here is the difference, and the learning science behind it.

WHERE THE MARKS ARE

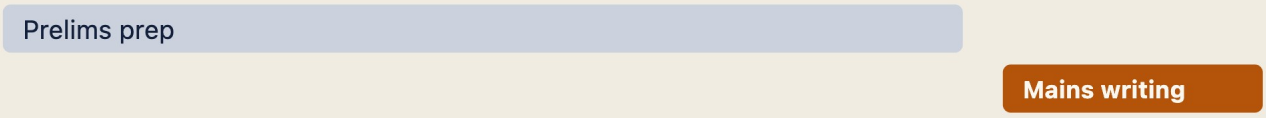
PRELIMS	MAINS	INTERVIEW
0 marks	1,750 marks	275

Final merit is 2,025 marks. Prelims adds nothing to your rank, but you cannot move forward without clearing it.

AN ILLUSTRATIVE STORY

The aspirant who aced the wrong exam.

WITHOUT A PLAN



Mock scores far above the cutoff, with answer writing starting only after the result.

WITH A PLAN



Prelims prep aims for a safe margin, and answer writing builds from the start.

Illustrative, not to scale. Time runs left to right.

Prelims is a gate, not a podium.

Clear it with a safe margin (cutoffs move every year), then put the saved hours where marks count.

Backward design: Grant Wiggins & Jay McTighe, 1998. Researchers are credited for published work; no affiliation or endorsement of [YOUR BRAND] is implied.

Six more findings that change how you study Turn over →

The science behind your plan.

Each finding comes from published research. Here is what it changes for you.



Remember longer

Spaced revision
Hermann Ebbinghaus, 1885

WITHOUT IT
You finish Polity in month 2 and relearn it from scratch in month 8.

WITH IT
Each topic returns on a schedule, so revision becomes a quick top-up.

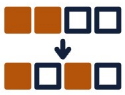


Recall, don't re-read

Retrieval practice
Roediger & Karpicke, 2006

WITHOUT IT
You re-read and highlight. It feels familiar, then goes blank in the exam hall.

WITH IT
You test yourself first, so you know what you actually know.



Think like the exam

Interleaving
Rohrer & Taylor, 2007

WITHOUT IT
Topic-wise tests look great, then a mixed mock paper shocks you.

WITH IT
Mixed practice trains you to spot which idea a question is testing.



Let effort work for you

Desirable difficulties
Robert A. Bjork, 1994

WITHOUT IT
You read for months before seeing what UPSC asks, and over-study what never appears.

WITH IT
You attempt past-year questions first, then read with a purpose.



Fix what is weak

Deliberate practice
K. Anders Ericsson, 1993

WITHOUT IT
You attempt 50 tests, repeat the same mistakes, and call it practice.

WITH IT
An error log finds the pattern behind your mistakes and sets next week's work.



Learn from strong answers

Worked examples
Sweller & Cooper, 1985

WITHOUT IT
You write from a blank page, with no sense of what a good answer looks like.

WITH IT
You dissect a strong answer first, then write your own and compare.



Benjamin Franklin practised this by hand.

In his Autobiography he describes noting the gist of Spectator essays, setting the notes aside for days, rebuilding each essay in his own words, then comparing it with the original.

Also built in: metacognition (John Flavell, 1979), so you know what you actually know; and feedback (John Hattie & Helen Timperley, 2007), because practice without feedback hardens mistakes.

[YOUR OFFER, e.g. free diagnostic test] **[YOUR URL OR QR]**

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